

Curriculum vitae

Education

2023 – 2027 (expected)	Doctor of Medicine (MD) Candidate University of British Columbia, Vancouver, BC
2021 – 2023	Master of Science, Biochemistry McGill University, Montréal, QC · Supervisor: Dr. Morag Park Thesis: Targeting chemotherapy-induced senescence escape to reduce breast cancer cell survival.
2017 – 2021	Bachelor of Science, Physiology and Pharmacology University of Toronto, Toronto, ON 3.99 cumulative GPA Minor in Economics Completed additional coursework in Python, bioinformatics, and statistics

Awards & scholarships

2026	ESCRS Bursary Award European Society of Cataract & Refractive Surgeons (ESCRS) Competitive bursary for the highest-scoring abstracts.
2026	Conquer Cancer Merit Award American Society of Clinical Oncology (ASCO) Annual Meeting One of 141 merit awards among over 8,500 abstracts submitted worldwide.
2026	Conquer Cancer Merit Award ASCO Quality Care Symposium One of 42 top-ranking abstracts selected among over 900 abstracts.
2024	Summer Student Research Program Award Faculty of Medicine, University of British Columbia
2021	Undergraduate Student Research Award Natural Sciences and Engineering Research Council of Canada (NSERC)
2018 – 2021	Undergraduate scholarships University of Toronto Dr. James A. & Connie P. Dickson Scholarship (2020, 2021) Alen Milne McCombie Scholarship (2019) Mary McWhorter Scholarship (2018)

Publications

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

- 01 **Zeng D**, Bates A, Zhang Y, Cook O, Raman S, Leung B, Ho C, Nunez JJ. The impact of social isolation and psychological distress on overall survival in cancer: a population-based cohort study. *JCO Oncology Practice*. Accepted for publication Aug 2026.
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- 02 Sagorin Z, **Zeng D**, Nguyen N, Yorke E, Sampath S. Intracorporeal anastomosis versus extracorporeal anastomosis for laparoscopic right hemicolectomy: short-term and long-term outcomes. *Surgical Endoscopy*. Published online Jul 13, 2026.
doi.org/10.1007/s00464-026-13128-2
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- 03 Yang K, Mircescu A, Okusanya D, Mohsen S, **Zeng D**, Czyz S, Vallerand I, Damiani G, Bunick C, Jafarian F. Understanding the atopic dermatitis–psoriasis phenotypic switch through a pharmacovigilance-based approach. *Journal of Investigative Dermatology*. Published online Jun 1, 2026.
doi.org/10.1016/j.jid.2026.05.012
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MANUSCRIPTS UNDER REVIEW

- 04 **Zeng D**, Bondok M, Tao B, Al-Ghoul A, Pintwala R. Ocular adverse events associated with taxane chemotherapy: a disproportionality analysis of pharmacovigilance data. *Journal of Ocular Pharmacology and Therapeutics*. Submitted Aug 2026.
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- 05 Kang M, Dhesa P, Dhillon R, **Zeng D**, Dhillon H, Uppal M, Gill K, Tao B, Navajas E. Regional trends in ophthalmic surgical wait times 2009–2024 in British Columbia, Canada: a retrospective study of the BC Surgical Wait Times dataset. *Canadian Journal of Ophthalmology*. Submitted Aug 2026.
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- 06 **Zeng D**, Wu E, Derocher H, Lin A, Siever J, Rao S, Lin T, Sit D, Murchison S, Sauciuc D, Atrchian S. Long-term outcomes and patterns of care in thymoma: a provincial cohort study. *Lung Cancer*. Submitted Sept 2026.
[Preprint](#)
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- 07 **Zeng D**, Ho A, Bondy S, Kong P, Cunningham J, Sidi S, Lee G, Kapoor V, Nakajima L, Sapkota DR. Improving sexual and reproductive health knowledge in a low-income rural community: the adolescent health program. *Global Health: Science and Practice*. Submitted Sept 2026.
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- 08 Sagorin Z, **Zeng D**, Nguyen N, Yorke E, Sampath S. Pfannenstiel versus midline extraction in laparoscopic right hemicolectomy with intracorporeal anastomosis: association with ileus, hernia, and infection risk. *BMC Surgery*. Submitted May 2026.
[Preprint](#)
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- 09 Li K, **Zeng D**, Thapar A, Belayneh M. Managing neuropathic cancer breakthrough pain for patients on methadone: a retrospective cohort study. *Journal of Pain & Palliative Care Pharmacotherapy*. Submitted Jul 2026.
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- 10 Yuan L, **Zeng D**, Atrchian S, Clarke K, Sulpher J. Clinical outcomes of rectal squamous cell carcinoma in British Columbia, Canada. *Journal of Gastrointestinal Cancer*. Submitted Jun 2026.
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- 11 Sheikh-Oleslami S, Daniels W, **Zeng D**, Abraha B, Tang D. Determinants of digit survival after replantation: injury topography and the complication cascade outweigh venous technique. *Journal of Hand Surgery*. Submitted Sept 2026.
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- 12 Lee AH, Kruger HJ, Chen J, **Zeng D**, Narayanan D, Oosthuizen G, Hameed SM. Current priorities and gaps in artificial intelligence for global trauma care. *Journal of Trauma and Acute Care Surgery*. Submitted Aug 2026.
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- 13 Yang K, Li M, Skinner T, **Zeng D**, Sosa G, Han JY, Jafarian F. A dietary approach to skin cancer prevention in solid organ transplant recipients: a perspective. *Frontiers in Transplantation*. Submitted Jul 2026.

Conference presentations

25 presentations in total: 12 oral, 13 poster. Presenting author underlined.

ORAL

- 01 **Zeng D**, Wong VT, Pintwala R. Acute angle-closure glaucoma and non-ophthalmic anticholinergics: a sex-stratified pharmacovigilance disproportionality analysis.
European Society of Cataract & Refractive Surgeons (ESCRS) Congress, London, UK, Sept 2026 5-MIN ORAL
ESCRS BURSARY AWARD
- 02 **Zeng D**, Bondok M, Tao B, Al-Ghoul A, Pintwala R. Ocular adverse events associated with taxane chemotherapy: a disproportionality analysis of pharmacovigilance data and a literature review.
Pan-American Association of Ophthalmology (PAAO) Research Day, Virtual, Aug 2026 3-MIN ORAL
- 03 **Zeng D**, Bates A, Zhang Y, Cook O, Raman S, Leung B, Ho C, Nunez JJ. Association of social isolation with overall survival in cancer patients.
American Society of Clinical Oncology (ASCO) Annual Meeting, Chicago, IL, May 2026 6-MIN ORAL
CONQUER CANCER MERIT AWARD
- 04 **Zeng D**, Ho A, Bondy S, Kong P, Cunningham J, Sidi S, Lee G, Kapoor V, Nakajima L, Sapkota DR. Improving sexual and reproductive health knowledge in a low-income rural community: the adolescent health program.
Western Medical Research Conference, Carmel, CA, Jan 2025 15-MIN ORAL
UBC FLEX Activity Day, Vancouver, BC, Jan 2025 1-MIN ORAL
- 05 Li K, **Zeng D**, Thapar A, Belayneh M. Managing neuropathic cancer breakthrough pain for patients on methadone: a retrospective cohort study.
Canadian Society of Palliative Medicine, Virtual, Sept 2025 10-MIN ORAL
UBC Division of Palliative Care Research Day, Vancouver, BC, Jun 2025 15-MIN ORAL
- 06 Sagorin Z, **Zeng D**, Nguyen N, Yorke E, Sampath S. Intracorporeal versus extracorporeal anastomosis for laparoscopic right hemicolectomy: short-term and long-term outcomes.
British Columbia Surgical Society, Victoria, BC, May 2024 15-MIN ORAL
UBC Department of Surgery Chung Research Day, Vancouver, BC, Nov 2024 4-MIN ORAL
- 07 Sagorin Z, **Zeng D**, Nguyen N, Yorke E, Sampath S. Postoperative incisional hernia rates comparing midline versus Pfannenstiel extraction site for laparoscopic right hemicolectomy with intracorporeal anastomosis.
British Columbia Surgical Society, Kelowna, BC, Apr 2025 15-MIN ORAL
- 08 Yuan L, **Zeng D**, Atrchian S, Clarke K, Sulpher J. Clinical outcomes of rectal squamous cell carcinoma in British Columbia, Canada.
Western Medical Students Summit, Calgary, AB, Feb 2025 7-MIN ORAL
- 09 **Zeng D**, Fortier AM, Park M. Targeting chemo-resistant triple-negative breast cancer.
Biochemistry Graduate Student Society Research Day, McGill University, Montréal, QC, Apr 2022 3-MIN ORAL

POSTER

- 01 **Zeng D**, Wong VT, Pintwala R. Acute angle-closure glaucoma risk with non-ophthalmic anticholinergics: sex-stratified pharmacovigilance analysis.
American Academy of Ophthalmology (AAO), New Orleans, LA, Oct 2026
POSTER PANEL DISCUSSION · 3-MIN ORAL
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- 02 **Zeng D**, Bondok M, Tao B, Al-Ghoul A, Pintwala R. Ocular adverse events associated with taxane chemotherapy: a disproportionality analysis of pharmacovigilance data.
Canadian Ophthalmological Society (COS), Montréal, QC, Jun 2026
Association for Research in Vision and Ophthalmology (ARVO), Denver, CO, May 2026
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- 03 **Zeng D**, Wong VT, Popovic M, Muni R, Pintwala R. Intraocular hemorrhage risk with antiplatelet agents: a pharmacovigilance analysis.
American Academy of Ophthalmology (AAO), New Orleans, LA, Oct 2026
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- 04 **Zeng D**, Murray N. Orbital trauma on CT: a systematic checklist to reduce missed vision-threatening injuries.
American Society of Emergency Radiology (ASER), Nashville, TN, Oct 2026
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- 05 **Zeng D**, Bates A, Zhang Y, Cook O, Raman S, Leung B, Ho C, Nunez JJ. Cumulative social isolation burden and overall survival in patients with cancer: a population-based cohort study.
American Society of Clinical Oncology (ASCO) Quality Care Symposium, Boston, MA, Oct 2026
CONQUER CANCER MERIT AWARD
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- 06 Yuan L, **Zeng D**, Atrchian S, Clarke K, Sulpher J. Clinical outcomes of rectal squamous cell carcinoma in British Columbia, Canada.
European Society for Medical Oncology (ESMO) Gastrointestinal Cancers Congress, Barcelona, Spain, Jul 2025
BC Cancer Summit, Vancouver, BC, Nov 2025
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- 07 Sagorin Z, **Zeng D**, Nguyen N, Yorke E, Sampath S. Postoperative ileus and incisional hernia: midline versus Pfannenstiel extraction site for laparoscopic right hemicolectomy with intracorporeal anastomosis.
Society of American Gastrointestinal and Endoscopic Surgeons (SAGES), Long Beach, CA, Mar 2025
Western Medical Students Summit, Calgary, AB, Feb 2025
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- 08 Li K, **Zeng D**, Thapar A, Belayneh M. Managing neuropathic cancer breakthrough pain for patients on methadone: a retrospective cohort study.
BC Cancer Summit, Vancouver, BC, Nov 2025
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- 09 **Zeng D**, Fortier AM, Park M. Targeting chemo-resistant triple-negative breast cancer.
Celebration of Research and Training in Oncology, Montréal, QC, May 2022
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- 10 **Qureshi Q**, Geyer A, Tan D, Chen S, Feng N, **Zeng D**, Delaney G, Garden FL, McKenzie P, Yap ML, Chan J. Global patterns in actual radiotherapy utilization for cancer: a systematic review and meta-analysis.
Canadian Association of Radiation Oncology (CARO), St. John's, NL, Sept 2026
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Research experience

OPHTHALMOLOGY

Feb 2026 – present	Acute Angle-Closure Glaucoma (ACG) & Non-Ophthalmic Anticholinergics Supervisors: Dr. Vincent Tony Wong, Dr. Rob Pintwala Leading a sex-stratified disproportionality analysis of ACG reporting in patients on non-ophthalmic anticholinergics; independently learned and applied R to conduct sensitivity analyses
Feb 2026 – present	Intraocular Hemorrhage & Antiplatelet Use Supervisors: Dr. Vincent Tony Wong, Dr. Rob Pintwala Integrating disproportional signals with existing evidence to draft a manuscript raising awareness of intraocular bleeding risk especially with clopidogrel and aspirin, independent of anticoagulant use
Sept 2025 – Aug 2026	Taxane Chemotherapy-Associated Ocular Adverse Events Supervisors: Dr. Rob Pintwala, Dr. Ahmed Al-Ghoul Calculated odds ratios, chi-square, and Bayesian information criterion for 258 ophthalmic outcomes Critically evaluated gaps in evidence, sources of bias, and study limitations for a structured literature review to support rigorous interpretation of significant FAERS signals
Apr 2026 – Jul 2026	Ophthalmic Surgical Wait Times Supervisor: Dr. Eduardo Navajas Investigated regional trends in ophthalmic surgical wait times across BC, with an emphasis on disparities in access for Indigenous communities Advocated for resource allocation to support more ophthalmic care in Indigenous communities
Jun 2026 – present	Intraocular Malignancy Collaborating with two medical students to screen 5,561 studies for a systematic review, resolving discrepancies by delegating tasks and communicating our decision-making process clearly
Aug 2026 – present	Visual Outcomes after Craniopharyngioma Surgery Screening 1,818 studies to determine predictors of visual improvement and deterioration after craniopharyngioma surgery; synthesizing findings for a systematic review

Sept 2025 – Jul 2026

Social Isolation & Cancer Survival

Supervisor: Dr. John-Jose Nunez

Recent cancer diagnosis in my mother motivated me to research the effects of psychosocial factors such as the many dimensions of social isolation on cancer survival

Led an analysis of a population cohort of 45,651 patients using Python; found that living alone, no regular social contact, and depressive or anxiety symptoms significantly increase mortality in cancer

Oct 2025 – Sept 2026

Thymoma Survival & Recurrence

Supervisor: Dr. Siavash Atrchian

Using competing risks analysis, estimated the long-term survival and recurrence of thymoma in a population-based cohort in BC followed for up to 21 years

Sept 2025 – Jun 2026

Global Radiotherapy Utilization

Supervisor: Dr. Jessica Chan

Screened 3,948 studies for a systematic review and meta-analysis comparing evidence-based radiotherapy need with real-world utilization

Extracting detailed information to characterize global inequities in access to cancer care

Nov 2024 – Sept 2026

Methadone for Breakthrough Neuropathic Cancer Pain

Supervisor: Dr. Mathieos Belayneh

Led a standardized chart review of 706 patients; identified methadone as the second-most common analgesic in BC for breakthrough neuropathic cancer pain

Data supported continued use of methadone as there were no documented severe adverse events

Apr 2024 – Jan 2026

Rectal Squamous Cell Carcinoma (rSCC) in BC

Supervisor: Dr. Jeffrey Sulpher

Collaborated with another medical student to analyze rSCC treatment patterns and outcomes in BC by standardizing data extraction and meeting regularly to resolve chart-review conflicts

Dec 2025 – Jul 2026

Chemoprevention Strategies in Transplant Recipients

Supervisor: Dr. Fatemeh Jafarian

Investigated strategies associated with reduced cutaneous malignancy in solid organ transplant recipients

Coordinated literature review and data extraction across a team of 5 medical students, delegating individual tasks to ensure smooth synthesis of evidence

SURGERY

Feb 2024 – May 2026

Surgical Technique & Laparoscopic Right Hemicolectomy Outcomes

Supervisor: Dr. Sharadh Sampath

Led a standardized review of 203 patient charts; examined associations of anastomotic technique and specimen-extraction site with short-term postoperative ileus and long-term incisional hernia

Mar 2026 – Jul 2026

Artificial Intelligence in Global Trauma Care

Supervisor: Dr. Morad Hameed

Spearheaded screening and data extraction of 1,046 studies for a systematic review of research priorities and gaps in artificial intelligence for trauma care in low-/middle-income countries

Sept 2024 – Aug 2026

Determinants of Digit Survival After Replantation

Supervisor: Dr. David Tang

Detailed chart review and analyses of all digital replantation patients in BC over 10 years revealed that injury topography and postoperative complications are predictive of digit outcomes

BASIC & COMPUTATIONAL SCIENCE

Sept 2019 – Jun 2021

Microglia in Neurodegeneration

Supervisor: Dr. Julien Muffat

Engineered doxycycline-inducible stem-cell models of microglial function using molecular cloning and CRISPR gene targeting, modelling mutant microglia with neurons

May 2019 – Sept 2020

Cytokines in Acute Myeloid Leukemia

Supervisor: Dr. Connie Eaves

Investigated cytokine-driven transformation to acute myeloid leukemia in vitro and in vivo

Sept 2018 – Apr 2019

Atherosclerosis COBWEB Model

Supervisor: Dr. Brad Bass

Developed 3 software models simulating blood-flow reduction across stages of atherosclerosis

Leadership & outreach

Everyone deserves the same standard of care, and in practice not everyone receives it. The languages you speak, how recently you immigrated, and how far you live from a hospital all change what happens. Each of these is an attempt to close that gap.

PATIENT ADVOCACY

Jul 2026 – present

Web Developer — Eyelingual

Developed and launched Eyelingual, a web-based tool for conducting ophthalmic examinations across a language barrier when live interpreter services are unavailable.

Bridging inequities in access to ophthalmic care by supporting communication with patients who prefer care in a language other than English.

Sept 2025 – present

Vision Mate Volunteer — Canadian National Institute for the Blind (CNIB) Foundation

Supported a client living with complete vision loss through biweekly meetings.

Built close rapport through companionship and practical assistance — reading mail, running errands, grocery shopping, and accompaniment on outings.

Oct 2024 – present

Patient Outreach & Interview — Patient Experience Project

Co-produced short films with patients sharing their lived experiences of illness and care.

Advocated for and secured their integration into the UBC MD curriculum, to foster a holistic understanding of illness and strengthen empathy for what patients live through.

Sept 2023 – May 2025

Newcomer Support — Refugee Health Initiative, UBC

Organized and delivered annual refugee-health outreach presentations at local community centres.

Provided a safe space and longitudinal support to a refugee family through monthly meetings, holding open discussion of resettlement challenges and adjustment.

Aug 2021 – present

Client Support — Shelter Movers

Worked in teams of 4–5 volunteers to move clients out of homes where they had experienced intimate partner violence, holding trauma-informed conversations where the client wanted them.

Aug 2024 – May 2025

Events Director — Women's Health Initiative, UBC

Designed and, with a physiotherapist, led a trauma-informed pelvic examination training session for medical students.

TEACHING & MENTORSHIP

Feb 2026 – Jul 2026

Educational Exhibit — Orbital Trauma on CT

Worked with radiologist Dr. Nicolas Murray to develop a systematic checklist that ensures vision-threatening orbital injuries are recognized on trauma imaging; designed the formal exhibit.

Oct 2023 – present	Sexual & Reproductive Health Program — Nepal Health Education, UBC Spearheaded changes to a sexual and reproductive health (SRH) education programme for adolescents in rural Nepal, based on local educator feedback, so the curriculum is culturally appropriate. Designed and facilitated the formal programme evaluation; advocated for delivery to early adolescents, where larger health-literacy gains were demonstrated in pre-menstruation females. Drafted thoroughly researched responses to commonly asked SRH questions.
Sept 2024 – present	Mentorship & Shadowing Executive — Oncology Interest Group, UBC Coordinated and facilitated numerous oncologist-led mentorship and clinical shadowing placements for other medical students.
Oct 2024 – Jun 2025	Cultural Competency Training — Global Health Initiative, UBC Facilitated sessions engaging other medical students in conversations on cultural humility before their global health projects, drawing on what I took away from my own visit to rural Nepal.

Skills & memberships

SKILLS AND LANGUAGES

Statistical analysis	R, Python, SPSS; survival analysis (Kaplan–Meier, Cox proportional hazards, competing risks); FDA Adverse Event Reporting System (FAERS) disproportionality analysis.
Laboratory	CRISPR gene targeting, molecular cloning, cell culture.
Evidence synthesis	Systematic review and meta-analysis (Covidence).
Languages	English; Mandarin Chinese (native speaker).
Interests	Scuba diving (PADI Advanced Open Water, certified in Koh Tao, Thailand); running (half-marathons and the Vancouver Sun Run); karate (performed a skit at the UBC Med Gala); photography.

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

Ophthalmology	Association for Research in Vision and Ophthalmology (ARVO) European Society of Cataract & Refractive Surgeons (ESCRS)
Oncology	American Society of Clinical Oncology (ASCO)

